ORDERS AND FULFILLMENT
Payments
Shipping
Tax
Orders
Overview
Refunds
Customizing printed invoices
CUSTOMERS AND SHOPPERS
Customers
Customer segmentation
Emails
System

Order Refunds

Order V3 exposes endpoints for creating refunds against orders with settled payments. These endpoints are useful when building order management or payment integrations as they make embedding refund functionality directly into the application possible without requiring merchants to return to their BigCommerce control panel.

This article provides an overview of Order's V3 refund capabilities and includes a step-by-step example for creating a single order refund.

Single order refund example

Refunding an order consists of two API requests.

Request	Operation	Endpoint	Description
1	POST	`/v3/orders/{id}/payment_actions/refund_quotes`	Calculate amounts and get payment methods
2	POST	`/v3/orders/{id}/payment_actions/refund`	Create the refund

The example requests in this article use an order with the following properties:

- **Products**: Single product priced at `$10.00`
- **Tax**: `$0.83`
- **Shipping**: `$10.00`

The refunded amount will include the shipping, tax, and product cost (a total of `$20.83`). We will create a refund quote. Then, we will create a refund using the information contained in the create refund quote response.

Creating refund quotes

A refund quote provides the tax amount, total refund amount, and a list of available payment methods for order refunds.

To create a refund quote, send a `POST` request to `/v3/orders/{order_id}/payment_actions/refund_quotes`.

Request | Response

Example request: Create a refund quote

```
POST https://api.bigcommerce.com/stores/{STORE_HASH}/v3/orders/{order_id}/payment_actions/refu
X-Auth-Token: {ACCESS_TOKEN}
Content-Type: application/json
Accept: application/json

{
  "items": [
    {
      "item_type": "PRODUCT",  // Refund a product
      "item_id": 8,            // Order product ID
      "quantity": 1,           // Quantity to refund
    },
    {
      "item_type": "SHIPPING", // Refund shipping
      "item_id": 9,            // Order address ID
      "amount": 10,            // Amount to refund
    },
    {
      "item_type": "ORDER",    // Tax-exempt order level refund
      "item_id": 9,            // Order ID
      "amount": 1,             // Amount to refund
    },
    {
      "item_type": "FEE",      // Refund a fee
      "item_id": 11,           // Fee ID
      "amount": 1,             // Amount to refund
    }
  ]
}
```

- To get an `item_id`, make a `GET` request to `v2/orders/{order_id}/products`. The returned `id` value is the `item_id` needed to create a `PRODUCT` refund quote. The returned `order_address_id` value is the `item_id` needed to create a `SHIPPING` refund quote. To read more about using the `v2/orders/{order_id}/products` endpoint, visit List Order Products.
- To get a list of orders and their `id`s, make a request to get all orders.

Creating a refund

Use the `provider_id`, the `amount`, and `items` from the refund quote to create a refund.

Request | Response

Example request: Create a refund

```
POST https://api.bigcommerce.com/stores/{STORE_HASH}/v3/orders/{order_id}/payment_actions/refu
X-Auth-Token: {ACCESS_TOKEN}
Content-Type: application/json
Accept: application/json

{
  "items": [
    {
      "item_type": "PRODUCT",  // Refund a product
      "item_id": 8,            // Order product ID
      "quantity": 1            // Quantity to refund
    },
    {
      "item_type": "SHIPPING", // Refund shipping
      "item_id": 9,            // Order address ID
      "amount": 10             // Amount to refund
    },
    {
      "item_type": "ORDER",    // Tax-exempt order level refund
      "item_id": 123,          // Order ID
      "amount": 1,             // Amount to refund
    },
    {
      "item_type": "FEE",      // Refund a fee
      "item_id": 11,           // Fee ID
      "amount": 1,             // Amount to refund
    }
  ],
  "payments": [
    {
      "provider_id": "braintree",
      "amount": 21.83,
      "offline": false
    }
  ]
}
```

Creating order level refunds

To refund a tax-exempt custom amount at the order level, set `item_type` to `ORDER` and specify the `amount` to refund.

Example request: Create a refund

```
POST https://api.bigcommerce.com/stores/{STORE_HASH}/v3/orders/{order_id}/payment_actions/refu
X-Auth-Token: {ACCESS_TOKEN}
Content-Type: application/json
Accept: application/json

{
  "order_id": 1234,
  "items": [
    {
      "item_type": "ORDER", // Refund a tax-exempt custom amount
      "item_id": 1234,      // Order ID
      "amount": 1,          // Amount to refund
    }
  ],
  "payments": [...]
}
```

Refunding shipping and handling

To refund shipping or handling, set `item_type` to `SHIPPING` or `HANDLING` and specify the `amount` to refund.

Example request: Create a refund

```
POST https://api.bigcommerce.com/stores/{STORE_HASH}/v3/orders/{order_id}/payment_actions/refu
X-Auth-Token: {ACCESS_TOKEN}
Content-Type: application/json
Accept: application/json

{
  "order_id": 1234,
  "items": [
    {
      "item_type": "SHIPPING", // Refund shipping
      "item_id": 456,          // Order address ID
      "amount": 1,             // Amount to refund
    }
  ],
  "payments": [...]
}
```

Refunding products and gift wrapping

To refund a product or gift wrapping, set `item_type` to `PRODUCT` or `GIFT_WRAPPING` and specify the `quantity` to refund.

Example request: Create a refund

```
POST https://api.bigcommerce.com/stores/{STORE_HASH}/v3/orders/{order_id}/payment_actions/refu
X-Auth-Token: {ACCESS_TOKEN}
Content-Type: application/json
Accept: application/json

{
  "order_id": 1234,
  "items": [
    {
      "item_type": "PRODUCT",       // Refund a product
      "item_id": 1234,              // Order product ID
      "quantity": 1,                // Quantity to refund
    },
    {
      "item_type": "GIFT_WRAPPING", // Refund gift wrapping
      "item_id": 1234,              // Order product ID
      "quantity": 1,                // Quantity to refund
    }
  ],
  "payments": [...]
}
```

Offline order refunds

Payments collected outside of BigCommerce can be marked as offline when creating a refund. Marking payments as offline is a way to keep track of which portions of an order you refunded. However, no funds were collected. If you did not receive payment using BigCommerce, then the funds can not be refunded directly to the payment source using BigCommerce's refund endpoints.

FAQ

Is it possible to create a refund without using an item from the order?

Yes. Set `item_type` to `ORDER` and specify an `amount` to refund. For more information, see create order level refunds.

Can I just skip creating the quote and go straight to processing a refund?

It is possible to process a refund without creating a quote first. Quotes serve to make sure you are refunding to the correct payment provider in the correct amount.

Where do I find the `item_id`?

Use the V2 Orders Endpoint to get the required ID:

- `PRODUCT` — Order Product ID
- `GIFT_WRAPPING` — Order Product ID
- `SHIPPING` — Order Address ID
- `HANDLING` — Order Address ID
- `ORDER` — Order ID

Will this trigger an email to the shopper?

Yes, if you configure the store to send an email when an order status changes to *Refunded* or *Partially Refunded*.

How do I get a list of `provider_id`s?

The POST Refund Quote exposes `provider_id`s.

Will a refunded item be returned to inventory?

No, you cannot return items to inventory that you refunded via API. You can either update the inventory directly on the product's page or use the Control Panel.

Troubleshooting

- You must receive payment of the order before you can issue a refund.
- If you use a payment gateway, it must support refunds. For a list of payment gateways that support refunds through BigCommerce, see the Supported Payment Gateways section in Processing Refunds.
- If you use a payment gateway, you must settle payments. Some gateways require a certain amount of time to pass before you can process refunds.

Related resources

Articles

- Orders Overview
- Order Webhook Events

Endpoints

- Orders V2 Reference
- Orders V3 Reference

Did you find what you were looking for?

On This Page
Single order refund example
Creating refund quotes
Creating a refund
Creating order level refunds
Refunding shipping and handling
Refunding products and gift wrapping
Offline order refunds
FAQ
Troubleshooting
Related resources
Articles
Endpoints

Join our community of thousands of developers
Enter your email
Join #BigCommerceDevs Slack
Join thousands of other #BigCommerceDevs that are building on BigCommerce. We will also keep you updated with our monthly BigCommerce Developers newsletter. You may opt out at any time.

Need help? Join our BigCommerceDevs Slack

Find endpoints quickly in the API reference

Stay up to date with Release notes

Visit BigCommerce home

Everything you need for growth, all from one modern platform.

© Copyright 2003 - 2025 BigCommerce Pty. Ltd. —— Contact Us Careers Terms of Service Privacy Policy